

Planting and Species Note for Two Mile Borris Tidy Towns 2026

Two Mile Borris's planters and beds are run as a multi-year transition toward pollinator-friendly perennials, in line with the All-Ireland Pollinator Plan. The list below is built from our actual 2025 to 2026 planting record across the village core, the seating area, the four approach roads, the church grounds and the residential estates.

How we choose what goes in

In order of priority:

1. **Pollinator value first.** Every variety earns its keep on the All-Ireland Pollinator Plan plant list.
2. **Clump-forming.** We divide our own stock between beds rather than buying in fresh annuals each year.
3. **Long flowering season.** The mix carries colour from March through to October across the planted areas.
4. **Hardy roadside conditions.** Full sun, free-draining soil, occasional salt spray.
5. **Simple open flowers.** Short-tongued bees can access them; no double-flowered or highly bred cultivars.
6. **Red and yellow as core colours.** Picks up the village flag colours flying on the GAA monument at the centre of the village.

Perennial mix in the planters and beds

Variety	Common name	What it brings
Mrs Bradshaw geum	Scarlet geum	Ruffled scarlet, late spring into summer
Coronation Gold yarrow	Yellow yarrow	Flat yellow plates, June onwards, drought-hardy
Prima Ruby echinacea	Coneflower	Late-summer cone display through into autumn
East Friesland salvia	Wood sage	Deep blue-purple spikes, bumblebee favourite
Red valerian	Valerian	Soft pinky-red wall-side panicles, very long flowering season
Tufted Hair Grass	Tussock grass	Airy golden seed plumes, structure and movement

All six are used in the cohesive blue trough planters made by a local tradesman from solid locally-sourced wood, now anchoring the cemetery layby, the Meadow Brook entrance, the former Dempsey & Harold Motors site, and the school's 1846 plaque on the L4202.

Spring and early-summer bulb programme (autumn 2025 planting, 11,100 bulbs)

The committee and the residential estates planted 11,100 bulbs together across the village in autumn 2025. Locations:

- Village seating area (west end of the main street)
- N75 west approach from the Thurles direction
- L4202 east approach, outside Leighton Manor
- Cluain Na Seimre entrance green, off the Ballyduff Road
- Glen Carraig limestone wall, eastern entrance
- Leighton Manor wildflower strip, eastern estate
- Inside the Ardleigh estate, across a number of front gardens and a small green

The bulbs were chosen to keep colour and pollen on the ground continuously from late winter into mid-summer, picking up the village flag colours (red and yellow) and a deep purple spring kick from the alliums. All five varieties are pollinator-friendly to varying degrees.

Variety	Number	Colour	Flowering window	Pollinator value
Ruby Giant crocus	5,000	Deep red-purple	Late February to March, around 4 weeks	Critical early-season pollen for queen bumblebees emerging from hibernation, plus hoverflies
Dutch Master daffodils	1,600	Bright trumpet yellow	Late February into April, 6 to 8 weeks	Useful for early bumblebee queens; the long flowering window is the main draw
Purple Sensation alliums	1,000	Deep purple globes on tall stems	May into June, 3 to 4 weeks	Strong bumblebee and hoverfly draw; one of the best pollinator bulbs going
Nigrum alliums	1,000	Creamy white globes on tall stems	Late May into early July, around 6 weeks	Bumblebees and hoverflies; the longer flowering window keeps the allium display going well after Purple Sensation has finished
Drumstick alliums	2,500	Egg-shaped maroon heads, shorter stems	June into July, 4 to 5 weeks	Bumblebee favourite, picks up where the bigger alliums leave off

Total invoice €1,143.51 across the committee and the residential estates that contributed. The committee's own share, including delivery, was roughly €320 inc VAT.

Photographs of the spring 2026 flush are included in the application's photo set.

Wildflower areas

An existing unmown wildflower bed sits within the St James Church grounds. Formal All-Ireland Pollinator Plan management of that bed (signed-off dock and thistle removal cycle, autumn cut-and-remove, signage) would follow if the parish chooses to take up the *Returning to Nature* initiative; that conversation is opening with Father Tom in May 2026.

Approach-road verges, the Old Road Triangle on the western edge of the village, and the proposed winter wildlife strips at the M8 end of the N75 are all on the May 2026 agenda with the Tipperary County Council Roads section and the County Biodiversity Officer.

Sources

- Project 012, "Cohesive village-wide pollinator planter scheme", on the public project tracker
- Project 047, "Annual bulb planting programme", on the public project tracker
- All-Ireland Pollinator Plan, pollinators.ie